THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE CHAPTER TEST SET A

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Draw neat maps and diagrams wherever required.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Colonialism is the practice in which one country: 1

(a) trades equally with another
(b) gives aid to another
(c) takes control of another region and imposes its systems
(d) signs a friendship treaty

2. Vasco da Gama arrived at Kappad near Kozhikode in: 1

(a) 1757 **(b)** 1510 **(c)** 1857 **(d)** 1498

3. Rani Abbakka II is remembered for using: 1

(a) fireballs from coconut shells **(b)** cannons
(c) elephants **(d)** poison arrows

4. The Carnatic Wars were fought between: 1

(a) the French and the British **(b)** Dutch and Portuguese
(c) Marathas and Mughals **(d)** British and Americans

5. At the Battle of Plassey (1757), the Nawab of Bengal was: 1

(a) Tipu Sultan **(b)** Siraj-ud-daulah **(c)** Bahadur Shah **(d)** Mir Jafar

6. At Independence there were over ___ princely states. 1

(a) 500 **(b)** 5 **(c)** 5000 **(d)** 50

7. 'The bones of the cotton weavers are bleaching the plains of India' was said by: 1

(a) Macaulay **(b)** William Bentinck **(c)** Clive **(d)** Metcalfe

8. Railways in colonial India were designed mainly to: 1

(a) help artisans
(b) connect village markets
(c) promote travel for fun
(d) move raw materials to ports and troops quickly

9. The Vellore Mutiny took place in: 1

(a) 1806 **(b)** 1835 **(c)** 1857 **(d)** 1757

10. **Assertion (A):** The Battle of Plassey gave the British a big advantage in Bengal. 1
Reason (R): Mir Jafar's forces, most of the Nawab's army, stood aside.
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 10–15 words each.

11. Define colonialism. 2

12. State two reasons for European colonisation. 2

13. Name the European powers that came to India. 2

14. What was the cartaz system? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

15. Explain why the Europeans were attracted to India. 3

16. Describe the Portuguese in India: arrival, Goa and the cartaz system. 3

17. Write on the Goa Inquisition. 3

OR

Describe the Dutch presence in India and their decline. 3

18. Describe the French in India. 3

OR

Explain how the British moved from traders to rulers. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

19. Explain colonialism and the reasons for European colonisation. How did the Europeans view India? 5

OR

Describe the Portuguese, Dutch and French in India with key events. 5

20. Explain how the British became rulers: divide and rule, Plassey, Doctrine of Lapse and Subsidiary Alliance. 5

OR

Describe the famines under British rule and the policies that worsened them. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

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